

Info Letter and Consent Form

Welcome to the Backyard Bird Project participant survey.

This survey asks about your backyard bird feeding and/or poultry practices, your perceptions of avian disease risk, and your conservation-related attitudes and behaviors. It takes about 10–15 minutes. Your participation is voluntary. You may skip any question or stop at any time. Your responses are kept confidential; they are labeled with a site code rather than your name, and the list linking codes to households is stored separately and securely, so your identity is not attached to your answers.

Please review the full Information Letter here: [[Information Letter \(PDF\)](#)]

By clicking "Next" below, you confirm that you have read the information above and agree to participate.

Screen

Are you at least 18 years old and currently participate in backyard bird watching or poultry keeping on your property?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Do you currently live in the Southeastern United States?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Block 1

Do you maintain bird feeders in your yard?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Block 2

Why do you feed birds in your yard? Please rate how important each reason is to you:

	Not important at all	Of little importance	Moderately important	Very important	Extremely important
To enjoy watching birds up close	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To feel connected to nature	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To help birds survive (especially in winter)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To teach my children/family about wildlife	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
For relaxation and stress relief	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To support local biodiversity	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

If cleaning, how often do you clean your bird feeders?

- ☐ o Daily
- ☐ o Weekly
- ☐ o Monthly
- ☐ o A few times per year

☐ o Rarely/Never

When cleaning feeders, which of the following do you use?
Check all that apply.

- ☐ o Water
- ☐ o Soap
- ☐ o Bleach solution (10% bleach)
- ☐ o Vinegar
- ☐ o Manual removal of litter/dirt
- ☐ o Other (please specify):

Do you make an effort to wash your hands after interacting with your feeder(s)?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Do you make an effort to wash your hands after interacting with your feeder(s)?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Please describe your favorite memory or experience related to feeding birds in your yard.

Block 3

Do you own backyard poultry, such as chickens, ducks or geese?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Block 4

Why do you keep backyard poultry? Please rate how important each reason is to you:

	Not important at all	Of little importance	Moderately important	Very important	Extremely important
To produce cheaper eggs/meat for my household	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To support sustainable/local food production	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To feel connected to nature and food sources	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
For relaxation and stress relief	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To teach children or family members about animal husbandry and sustainability	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
To enjoy watching and caring for the chickens	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

If cleaning, how often do you clean your poultry area(s)?

- ☐ o Daily
- ☐ o Weekly
- ☐ o Monthly
- ☐ o A few times per year
- ☐ o Rarely/Never

When cleaning poultry area(s), which of the following do you use? Check all that apply.

- ☐ o Water
- ☐ o Soap
- ☐ o Bleach solution (10% bleach)
- ☐ o Vinegar
- ☐ o Manual removal of litter/dirt
- ☐ o Other (please specify): _ _ _ _ _

Do you make an effort to wash your hands after interacting with backyard poultry and their enclosures?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

How often do you see wild birds interacting with or near your poultry coop, water sources, or feed?

- ☐ o Daily
- ☐ o A few times per week
- ☐ o A few times per month

☐ o Rarely☐ o Never

Please describe your favorite memory or experience related to keeping backyard chickens.

Block 4

Please rate your agreement with the following statements about your yard/property:

	Strongly disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Strongly agree
I am very attached to my backyard	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My backyard is very special to me	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I identify strongly with the nature in my backyard	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly disagree	Somewhat disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Somewhat agree	Strongly agree
My backyard is the best place to experience nature and wildlife	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
No other place can compare to my backyard; not parks, public spaces, or other natural areas	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I would rather participate in conservation activities that take place on my own property compared to elsewhere	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How much do you know about diseases that can spread from wild birds or backyard poultry to humans (zoonotic diseases)?

- ☐ I have never heard of zoonotic diseases
- ☐ I have heard the term but don't know what it means
- ☐ I know a little about zoonotic diseases
- ☐ I know a moderate amount about zoonotic diseases
- ☐ I know a great deal about zoonotic diseases

How familiar are you with the following diseases affecting birds or poultry in your yard?

	Not at all familiar	Slightly familiar	Moderately familiar	Very familiar	Extremely familiar	Not concerned/aware
Salmonella / E. coli infection	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Avian Pox	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Avian influenza (bird flu)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How likely do you think each of the following are to happen in your backyard or on your property?

	Not at all likely	Slightly likely	Moderately likely	Very likely	Extremely likely
Shared resources like soil, bird food or surfaces acting as disease reservoirs in my backyard	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
A wild bird becomes infected at my feeder	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
A wild bird dies in my backyard from disease	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Not at all likely Slightly likely Moderately likely Very likely Extremely likely

A disease outbreak at my feeder/property could spread to neighboring properties

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

How likely do you think it is that a spillover event (a disease jumping from wild birds to humans, pets, or backyard chickens) could happen in your area?

- ☐ Not at all likely
☐ Slightly likely
☐ Moderately likely
☐ Very likely
☐ Extremely likely

How serious of a threat do you believe avian diseases pose to:

Not serious at all Slightly serious Moderately serious Very serious Extremely serious

Your own health and safety

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Your family's health

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

	Not serious at all	Slightly serious	Moderately serious	Very serious	Extremely serious
Wild bird populations	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Your backyard chickens (if applicable)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How serious do you think the current impacts of avian disease are in the Southeastern US?

- ☐ Not serious at all
- ☐ Slightly serious
- ☐ Moderately serious
- ☐ Very serious
- ☐ Extremely serious

In the past 12 months, have you engaged in any of the following actions? Check all that apply.

- ☐ Provided food or water for wild animals other than birds
- ☐ Provided shelter for wild animals (like bird houses or baths, bat boxes, brush piles)
- ☐ Planted pollinator-friendly or native plants
- ☐ Avoided using pesticides/insecticides
- ☐ Picked up litter around your community
- ☐ Donated to a conservation organization

- ☐ Volunteered with a conservation group
- ☐ Voted for pro-environmental conservation policies or candidates
- ☐ Talked to friends/family about conservation issues/activities
- ☐ Read articles or information about environmental conservation or sustainability
- ☐ None of the above

After observing birds at your feeder, have you ever taken any conservation-related actions (e.g., planted native plants, talked about it, donated, changed yard practices)?

- ☐ Yes - Please describe below.
- ☐ No

Describe your willingness to make a donation to support bird conservation efforts if it specifically funded the following initiatives:

	Definitely not willing	Probably not willing	Unsure / Neutral	Probably willing	Definitely willing
Native bird conservation programs (e.g., habitat restoration, wildlife preserve creation, species monitoring)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Definitely
not willingProbably
not willingUnsure /
NeutralProbably
willingDefinitely
willing

Easy-to-clean, take-apart bird feeder designs to support the development of feeders that reduce disease transmission

☐☐☐☐☐

Disease prevention and monitoring programs (e.g., testing feeders for pathogens, public education on zoonotic disease, bird health and safety)

☐☐☐☐☐

Community education programs about backyard bird biodiversity, bird-friendly yards and sustainability

☐☐☐☐☐

Approximately how much would you be willing to donate per year to support these efforts?

- ☐ o Less than \$10
- ☐ o \$10–\$25
- ☐ o \$26–\$50
- ☐ o \$51–\$100
- ☐ o More than \$100
- ☐ o Prefer not to say

21. Do you buy bird seed more than once a year?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

How do you choose which bird seed to buy?

- ☐ Seed that will be the least messy
- ☐ Seed that will deter rodent species (squirrels)
- ☐ Seed that will attract specific bird species; If so, please list species below:

- ☐ Seed that is the healthiest for wild birds
- ☐ Seed that is the most affordable
- ☐ Seed that was recommended by store personnel/social media/news articles

Block 5

Age:

Gender:

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Non-binary
- ☐ Prefer not to say

Income:

- ☐ o Less than \$25,000
- ☐ o \$25,000–\$49,999
- ☐ o \$50,000–\$74,999
- ☐ o \$75,000–\$99,999
- ☐ o \$100,000–\$149,999
- ☐ o \$150,000 or more
- ☐ o Prefer not to say

Education Level

- ☐ Less than high school
- ☐ High school diploma or GED

- ☐ Some college
- ☐ Associates degree
- ☐ Bachelors degree
- ☐ Professional degree
- ☐ Doctorate
- ☐ Prefer not to say

Number of children in current houshold:

Number of pets in current houshold:

Length of time at current residence:

Acreage of property:

6. Residential Area/Postal code:

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